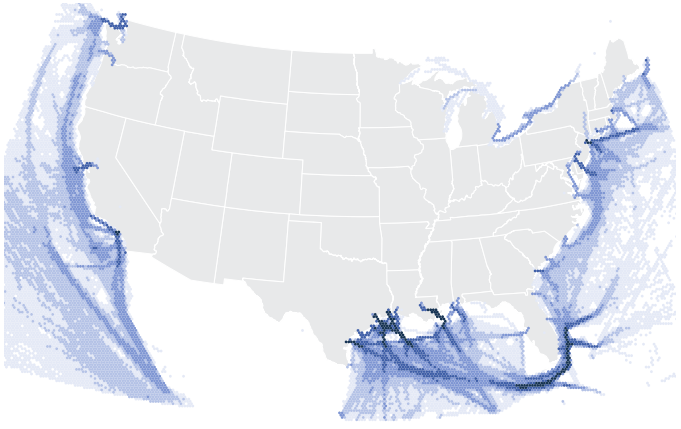
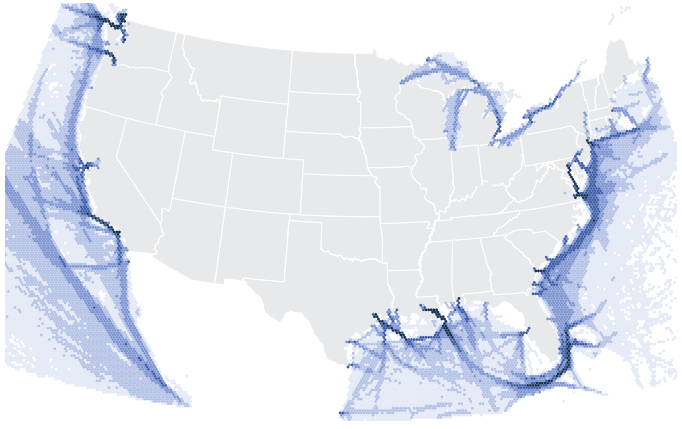
87% of tankers sail in Gulf waters, against 51% of cargo ships; passenger and government ships cluster at a few ports

Distinct ships of each type per 25 km hexagon, 2023 and 2024 together (each map has its own shading)

Tankers (4,452 ships)



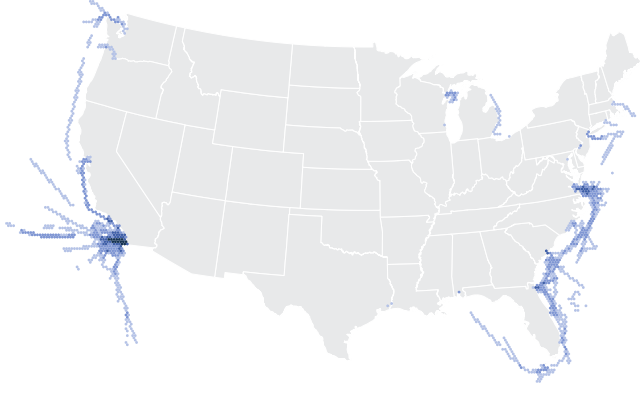
Cargo and container ships (10,216 ships)



Passenger ships (282 ships)



Military and law enforcement (68 ships)



Source: NTIA analysis of MarineCadastre AIS, 104 sampled days in 2023 and 2024; large ships = cargo, tanker, passenger, military, and other seagoing ships 100 m or longer, plus tug-barges near the coast. Types from the AIS ship-type code: tanker 80-89, cargo 70-79, passenger 60-69, military 35, law enforcement 55.